

098. Chapter 8 Verses 1-4

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 8.1-2

अर्जुन उवाच ।
किं तद्ब्रह्म किमध्यात्मं किं कर्म पुरुषोत्तम ।
अधिभूतं च किं प्रोक्तमधिदैवं किमुच्यते ॥१॥
अधियज्ञः कथं कोऽत्र देहेऽस्मिन्मधुसूदन ।
प्रयाणकाले च कथं ज्ञेयोऽसि नियतात्मभिः ॥२॥

arjuna uvācha

kiṁ tad brahma kim adhyātmam kiṁ karma puruṣhottama
adhibhūtam cha kiṁ proktam adhidaivam kim uchyate
adhiyajñam katham ko 'tra dehe 'smin madhusūdana
prayāṇa-kāle cha katham jñeyo 'si niyatātmabhiḥ

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **kim**—what; **tad**—that; **brahma**—Brahman; **kim**—what; **adhyātmam**—the individual soul; **kim**—what; **karma**—the principle of karma; **puruṣha-uttama**—Shree Krishna, the Supreme Divine Personality; **adhibhūtam**—the material manifestation; **cha**—and; **kim**—what; **proktam**—is called; **adhidaivam**—the Lord of the celestial gods; **kim**—what; **uchyate**—is called; **adhiyajñam**—the Lord all sacrificial performances; **katham**—how; **kaḥ**—who; **atra**—here; **dehe**—in body; **asmin**—this; **madhusūdana**—Shree Krishna, the killer of the demon named Madhu; **prayāṇa-kāle**—at the time of death; **cha**—and; **katham**—how; **jñeyam**—to be known; **asi**—are (You); **niyata-ātmabhiḥ**—by those of steadfast mind

Arjuna said: O Supreme Lord, what is Brahman (Absolute Reality), what is adhyatma (the individual soul), and what is karma? What is said to be adhibhuta, and who is said to be Adhidaiva? Who is Adhiyajna in the body and how is He the Adhiyajna? O Krishna, how are You to be known at the time of death by those of steadfast mind?

VERSE 8.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

अक्षरं ब्रह्म परमं स्वभावोऽध्यात्ममुच्यते ।

भूतभावोद्भवकरो विसर्गः कर्मसंज्ञितः ॥३॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

akṣharaṁ brahma paramaṁ svabhāvo 'dhyātmam uchyate

bhūta-bhāvodbhava-karo visargaḥ karma-sanjñitaḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Lord said; **akṣharam**—indestructible; **brahma**—Brahman; **paramam**—the Supreme; **svabhāvaḥ**—nature; **adhyātmam**—one's own self; **uchyate**—is called; **bhūta-bhāva-udbhava-karaḥ**—actions pertaining to the material personality of living beings, and its development; **visargaḥ**—creation; **karma**—fruitive activities; **sanjñitaḥ**—are called

The Lord said: Brahman is supreme, imperishable. Its essential nature is called Adhyatma (Self-knowledge); the act of sacrifice that causes the birth of beings is named karma (action).

VERSE 8.4

अधिभूतं क्षरो भावः पुरुषश्चाधिदैवतम् ।
अधियज्ञोऽहमेवात्र देहे देहभृतां वर ॥ ४ ॥

adhibhūtaṁ kṣharo bhāvaḥ puruṣhaśh chādhidaivatam
adhiyajño 'ham evātra dehe deha-bhṛitām vara

adhibhūtam—the ever changing physical manifestation; **kṣharah**—perishable; **bhāvaḥ**—nature; **puruṣhaḥ**—the cosmic personality of God, encompassing the material creation; **cha**—and; **adhidaivatam**—the Lord of the celestial gods; **adhiyajñaḥ**—the Lord of all sacrifices; **aham**—I; **eva**—certainly; **atra**—here; **dehe**—in the body; **deha-bhṛitām**—of the embodied; **vara**—O best

O best of the embodied souls, the physical manifestation that is constantly changing is called adhibhūta; the universal form of God, which presides over the celestial gods in this creation, is called Adhidaiva; I, who dwell in the heart of every living being, am called Adhiyajna, or the Lord of all sacrifices.